

Girl's Podcast About Dyslexia Wins Big Prize

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Cora Walsh is a seventh-grader from Long Island, New York. She won the middle-school **grand prize** in NPR's Student **Podcast** Challenge.

Her **podcast** is called "**Dyslexia** and MEE." It tells how she learned why reading was hard. Cora has **dyslexia**, a learning difference that can make reading tougher. She said it took almost five years to get the right **diagnosis**.

Nearly 1,500 **podcasts** were sent in from 42 states and Washington, D.C. Cora felt excited to win. Her mom, Emily Johnson, said she was proud of Cora's hard work.

Cora has had **tutoring** for two years. She says she reads better now and likes it more. This summer she even read a Hunger Games book for fun. She hopes her **podcast** helps other kids who learn in different ways.

Word Treasure

dyslexia -- A learning difference that can make reading harder.

diagnosis -- An official finding about what condition someone has.

podcast -- An audio show you can listen to on a phone or computer.

tutoring -- Extra teaching that helps someone practice a skill.

grand prize -- The top award in a contest.

Background you need

Dyslexia is a common learning difference that mainly affects reading. Many students improve with extra practice and support outside class. Student contests let kids share their own stories in creative formats like podcasts.

Break it down

WHO: Cora Walsh, a seventh-grader; her mom Emily Johnson

WHAT: Won NPR's middle-school podcast prize for "Dyslexia and MEE"

WHERE: Long Island, New York

WHY: To share her path with dyslexia and help other kids

Why it matters

Hearing a kid's story about learning differences can encourage classmates who also struggle with reading.

Test what you remember

1. What contest did Cora win?

- ☐ (A) NPR's Student Podcast Challenge
- ☐ (B) A soccer tournament
- ☐ (C) A baking show
- ☐ (D) A space race

2. What is Cora's podcast called?

- ☐ (A) Night Sky
- ☐ (B) Dyslexia and MEE
- ☐ (C) Space News
- ☐ (D) Dog Brains

3. About how long did getting the right diagnosis take?

- ☐ (A) Two days
- ☐ (B) Almost five years
- ☐ (C) One month
- ☐ (D) Ten years

4. Where is Cora from?

- ☐ (A) Houston
- ☐ (B) Vienna
- ☐ (C) Arizona
- ☐ (D) Long Island, New York

5. How long has Cora had tutoring?

- ☐ (A) Twenty years
- ☐ (B) Two days
- ☐ (C) Never
- ☐ (D) Two years

6. What book did she read for fun this summer?

- ☐ (A) A phone manual
- ☐ (B) A tax form
- ☐ (C) A Hunger Games book
- ☐ (D) A bike catalog

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: B 3: B 4: D 5: D 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Cora Walsh: Says she feels excited and hopes to help other kids.
2. Emily Johnson: Says she is proud of Cora's hard work.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):